

11 Ways Companies Legally Owe You Money

When the law says they owe you, what it's typically worth, and the official place to claim it — free. (Want the exact fill-in letters and word-for-word scripts done for you? Those are in the Complete Recovery Kit.)

1. Canceled or Significantly Changed Flight

Typical amount: \$150–\$1,500+ per ticket

When: Flight canceled OR time shifts 3+ hours (domestic) / 6+ hours (international) and you decline rebooking.

File complaint: transportation.gov/airconsumer

2. Late Checked Bag

Typical amount: \$30–\$100 per bag

When: Bag arrives 12+ hours late (domestic) or 15–30 hours (international). **Must file mishandled-baggage report at airport!**

Same link: transportation.gov/airconsumer

3. Surprise Junk Fees (State Laws)

Typical amount: \$20–\$50 per night (resort fees, etc.)

When: Mandatory fee never disclosed upfront. Federal rule tied up in court; CA, NY, and other states have their own all-in pricing laws NOW.

Dispute with merchant, then card issuer if denied.

4. Product That Broke Too Soon

Typical amount: \$50–\$500+ (product replacement/refund)

When: Product fails in unreasonably short time, even after written warranty ends. Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act + state implied-warranty laws.

FTC guidance: ftc.gov/warranties

5. Price Drop After You Bought

Typical amount: \$10–\$200 (depends on item)

When: Item goes on sale within 14–30 days (store policy, not federal law). Many major retailers honor this; some credit cards offer price protection.

Check store return policy or card benefits guide.

6. Unclaimed Property Held by Your State

Typical amount: \$50–\$2,000+ (avg ~\$892)

When: Old deposits, final paychecks, insurance, forgotten accounts. States hold \$70+ billion; ~1 in 7 Americans has money waiting.

Search free: missingmoney.com + unclaimed.org (every state you've lived/worked)

7. Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC)

Typical amount: \$600–\$8,000 per year (refundable!)

When: Low-to-moderate earned income + you file a tax return. 1 in 5 eligible people never claim it. Can go back 3 years!

Check eligibility: IRS EITC Assistant at irs.gov (search "EITC Assistant")

File free: IRS Free File or find a VITA site at irs.treasury.gov/freetaxprep

8. Surprise Medical Bill (No Surprises Act)

Typical amount: \$500–\$10,000+ wiped away

When: Emergency care or certain services at in-network hospital where you're balance-billed by out-of-network provider. Federal law blocks this since 2022.

File complaint: cms.gov/nosurprises or call 1-800-985-3059

9. Subscription You Forgot to Cancel

Typical amount: \$10–\$50/month (adds up fast!)

When: Charged after trial you tried to cancel, or hard-to-cancel subscription. Federal "click-to-cancel" rule struck down 2025, but CA/NY/others have state laws NOW.

Comb statements, cancel forgotten subs, dispute recent charges with card issuer.

10. Bank Fees You Can Get Reversed

Typical amount: \$25–\$35 per overdraft

When: Overdraft, NSF, or other fees — especially first-time or loyal customer. Federal overdraft rule was repealed 2025, but banks often reverse fees if you ask!

Call your bank. If refused, file CFPB complaint: consumerfinance.gov/complaint

11. Class-Action Settlements

Typical amount: \$5–\$500+ (sometimes more)

When: Company you bought from settles lawsuit (data breach, hidden fee, mislabeled product). You're owed a share if you used the product/service.

Check official settlement sites (always free): search for settlements by company name or check classaction.org for open claims.

Brought to you by Money You're Owed — the channel that helps you claim what's rightfully yours.

Want it done for you? The Complete Recovery Kit turns all 11 into ready-to-send letters, word-for-word phone scripts, and a tracker — at moneyyoureowed.com.

General educational information, not legal or financial advice. Based on laws and rules in effect as of June 2026; always confirm current details at the official links above before taking action. Never pay a "finder" or recovery service to claim money that is already legally yours.